

The Dream Garden

An original bedtime story for ages 4–7. Reading time: about 4 minutes.



Kids Book Videos



Suri the squirrel brushed her teeth and put on her pajamas. She climbed into her leafy bed. But her mind would not be quiet. She felt worried about tomorrow.

Tomorrow was the big nut-gathering day. What if she was too slow? What if she found no nuts at all? The worries buzzed around like busy bees.

Her grandmother had told her a secret. "When worries visit at bedtime," Grandma said, "plant them in the Dream Garden."



Suri tiptoed to the garden behind her tree. Moonlight made the flowers glow silver. In the middle stood a small empty pot. A wooden sign read: PLANT WORRIES HERE.

Suri closed her eyes. She gathered up her buzzy worries. She dropped them into the pot like tiny seeds. Plip. Plop. Plip.

"Now water it," whispered the night breeze.



Suri did not have a watering can. So she watered it the special way. She gave the pot a great big yawn. Yawns are the very best water for worry seeds.

"Grow soft, grow slow, let your worries go," she sang.

A tiny green sprout poked up. It stretched toward the moon. It grew two round leaves. Then a bud appeared, blue as bedtime.

"Grow soft, grow slow, let your worries go," Suri sang again.



The bud opened into a beautiful flower. Its petals were soft as pajamas. It smelled like warm milk and honey. The flower swayed gently in the breeze.

"Grow soft, grow slow, let your worries go," Suri sang one last time.

The flower began to hum a lullaby. Its hum was low and sweet. Suri's buzzy worries melted away. She felt calm and peaceful. Tomorrow would take care of itself.



She carried the flower back to her bed. She set it on her windowsill. Its petals glowed softly in the dark, like a tiny nightlight.

Suri snuggled under her blanket. Her eyes felt heavy. Her tail curled around her like a scarf. The flower hummed its sleepy song.

Sleep now, little squirrel. Your worries have bloomed into something beautiful. Rest soft until the morning sun.

Moral: *Worries grow smaller when you set them down before sleep.*

The End